



Elder Life Transitions

Guidance from a Former Executive Director of Senior Living

Your Parent Has to Move — Here's Where to Start

A short orientation for the first hours after a care transition notice

A transition notice is unsettling, even when you understand why it happened. I've handed this same notice to families myself, and I've watched what happens in the days after. Take a breath — there is a path forward, and you don't have to find it by guesswork.

Which of These Describes Your Situation?

Every transition is a little different, and the honest answer changes what happens next:

- A standard transition — no major behavior or safety concerns, just a need for the right next fit
- A behavior-driven transition — aggression, elopement risk, or safety concerns are part of why this community can't continue care
- Already turned away — you've started calling around, and communities are declining to accept

If you're in the second or third group, this is worth knowing now: most families don't discover until deep into a frustrating search that specialized paths exist for exactly this — and that a standard search was never going to be the right one.

Where to Start Today

1. Before you leave this conversation: ask whether any extension is possible, and make sure you have the exact move-out date in writing.
2. If your situation matches either harder category above, don't start calling communities on your own yet — book the call below first. The right next step looks different from a standard search, and it's easy to lose your best options by guessing at it alone.



Book Your Crisis Clarity Call

I'm David Johnstone. I spent years as an Executive Director of assisted living, memory care, and independent living communities. I've sat on the other side of the exact discharge letter you may be holding right now. I will not take any referral fees related to this service — my only job is telling you the truth about your options.

Start with a free 20-minute Crisis Clarity Call — it's the first step toward getting hands-on help finding and securing the right next placement, while you focus on your family.

Scan the code, or visit elderlifetransitions.net/next-steps



P.S. — If your move-out date is this week, say so when you book. I prioritize those calls.